GARISSA UNIVERSITY
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION, ARTS & SOCIAL SCIENCES

EMP 8123: LEADERSHIP IN EDUCATION (3 UNITS)

Purpose of the Course

This course is designed to examine the current theories and belief systems that contribute to evolving concepts of leadership, particularly in educational settings. A variety of pedagogical approaches will be used to examine processes that develop relationships, encourage team building, facilitate conflict resolution, and encourage innovation, change, and organizational performance. Participants will become familiar with various styles of leadership such as transformational, transactional, pedagogical, and distributed, and will be encouraged to examine and challenge their own practices in field settings. Participants will develop a repertoire of leadership styles and skills that will be applicable in a variety of educational settings.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

1. Compare current leadership theories and belief systems.
2. Analyze how leadership is practiced in a variety of leadership settings.
3. Critique models for supervision and evaluation of staff in different leadership contexts.
4. Apply principles of leadership relating to the development of relationships, team building, and conflict resolution.
5. Outline innovative ways to adapt to change in a broad societal context.
6. Develop strategies for leadership with diverse classrooms and communities.

Course Content

- Leadership and leadership theory: deconstructing leadership
- Leadership Theories: Great-Man Theory, Trait Theory, Contingency Theories (Situational), Style and Behavior Theory, Process Leadership Theory, Transactional Theory, Transformational Theory.
- Leadership Styles: Transactional leadership, Transformational leadership, Pedagogical/Instructional leadership.
- The five levels of leadership: Position, permission, production, people development, pinnacle
- Factors in successful school leadership
- Developing leadership in others: **distributed leadership**, supporting the development of new leaders.
- Teambuilding and leading a learning community: team leadership model, building and leading a learning community.
- Developing relationships and building trust: emotional intelligence, building stakeholder relationships: application of leadership, working in teams.
- Conflict resolution and managing effectively: conflict resolution; constructive conflict.

- Facilitating innovation and change within a broader societal context: change theory, relationship of school and community.
- Diversity, inclusion, and leadership: diversity policy and practice
- Individual leadership case study - a second look: reflections on leadership learning.

Mode of Delivery

i. Face to face engagements (lectures, seminars, class discussions and presentations, workshops, practicals)
ii. Distance learning (video lectures, discussions forums, quizzes, practical assignments)
iii. e-learning (video lectures, discussions forums, quizzes, practical assignments)
iv. Research (Library, field work)
v. Field work / community service
vi. Case study analyses

Instructional Material / Equipment

Books, writing board, handouts, overhead projector, laptop and LCD slides, library resources, e-books, e-journals, and internet resources.

Course Assessment

Assessment Type	**Weighting *(%)***
Continuous Assessment Tests	40%
End of semester Examination	60%
Total	100%

Core reading materials

Bush, T. (2020) Theories of Educational Leadership and Management. London: Sage Publications Ltd.

Humphrey, R.H. (2014). *Effective Leadership: Theory, Cases and Applications*. London: Sage Publication Inc.

Miller, P.W. (2018). *The Nature of School Leadership*: Global Practice Perspectives. New York: Springer International Publishing.

Recommended reading materials

Arenas, F.J. (2019). *A Casebook for Transformational and Transactional Leadership*. Thames, Oxfordshire-UK: Taylor and Francis.

Baporikar, N. and Sony, M. (2020), *Quality Management Principles and Policies in Higher Education*. Hershey, PA-USA: IGI Global/.

Chatwani, N. (2018) Distributed Leadership: The Dynamics of Balancing Leadership with Followership. Zurich: Palgrave-Macmillan.

Edmondson, S. et al. (2013). *Managing Conflict: Strategies for School Leaders*. New York: Taylor and Francis.

Fiore, D.J. (2016). *School-Community Relations*. New York: Taylor Francis.

Roy, S.R. (2015) Promoting Trait Emotional Intelligence in Leadership and Education. Hershey, PA-USA: IGI Global/.

Gibson, C, and S. Mader. (2019). *Building Teaching and Learning Communities: Creating Shared Meaning and Purpose.* Illinois: Association of College and Research Libraries.

Schuelka, M.J. et al (Eds) (2019). *The Sage Handbook of Inclusion and Diversity in Education*. London: Sage Publications Ltd.

Shields, C.M. (2017). Transformative Leadership in Education: Equitable and Socially Just Change in an Uncertain and Complex World. London: Routledge.

Sidorkin, A.M. and Warford, M.K. (2017) *Reforms and Innovation in Education: Implications for the Quality of Human Capital*. New York: Springer International Publishing.

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EDU 8123: LEADERSHIP IN EDUCATION

September-December Semester 2025/2026

2025 Class @ 1.2

Facilitator: Dr Aden Ali

Assessment Task: Applying John C. Maxwell's 5 Levels of Leadership to the Kenyan School System

Description of the task

Critically analyze how John Maxwell's Five Levels of Leadership can be applied to enhance effective leadership and management in Kenyan schools. Discuss how school leaders at the primary or secondary school level can transition through these stages to improve teacher performance, student outcomes, and overall school development. Provide examples from Kenyan schools to support your arguments.

Your written assignment should contain the following elements

1. Introduction (1 page)
    - Briefly introduce John C. Maxwell's 5 Levels of Leadership and their significance in organizational development.
    - Provide a concise overview of the current state of leadership within the Kenyan school system, highlighting key challenges and opportunities.
2. Literature Review (2 pages)
    - Critically review existing literature on leadership theories, with a specific focus on transformational, servant, and distributed leadership models.
    - Analyze relevant research on the application of leadership frameworks in educational contexts, particularly in developing countries.
    - Explore the existing body of knowledge on the challenges and opportunities of leadership development within the Kenyan education system.
3. Discussion (2 pages)
    - Analyze the findings in the literature in relation to Maxwell's 5 Levels of Leadership.
        - At which level does leadership currently operate within the Kenyan school system?
        - What are the evidence-based examples of leadership practices at each level?
    - Discuss the potential benefits and challenges of implementing a leadership development programme based on Maxwell's model in the Kenyan context.
    - Discuss the implications of the findings for educational policy and practice in Kenya.

4. Recommendations (max 100 words)
    - Provide specific, actionable recommendations for improving leadership development within the Kenyan school system.
5. Conclusion (max 2 paragraphs)
    - Summarize the key concepts.
    - Offer concluding remarks on the significance of effective leadership for improving the quality of education in Kenya.

Learning Outcomes of the Assessment Task
The task seeks to enable students:

- Engage in rigorous research and critical thinking.
- Apply theoretical frameworks to real-world educational challenges.
- Contribute to the ongoing discourse on leadership development and educational improvement in Kenya.
- Demonstrate knowledge and skills of academic writing.

Expectations of the Task

- Write a paper of not more than 6 pages.
- Provide you name, registration number and details of the course on the cover page.
- The task should be typed in Times New Roman font 12 at 1.15pt line spacing.
- Incorporate citations from relevant literature (in-text citation and references following APA 7th edition format). Endeavour to use citation management tools such as Zotero or Mendeley.
- The completed task should be student's own work. Do not duplicate or copy another student's work. Every student's work will be subjected to plagiarism check. Students whose assignments are found to have a resemblance of more than 10% will have their results cancelled.
- The work should be a coherent piece of writing with a well organised paper layout including grammar, punctuation, paragraphing, and typesetting.
- The assessment task will be **submitted online**. Hard copy submission will **NOT** be accepted. The task is due for submission on **10th December 2025**. To upload your work, click on this link https://www.dropbox.com/request/1v3FYfuSGh6Ns7UjRFGT then click "choose files", fill in your *first name*, *surname* and *email*, then click upload. You may copy and paste the link in your web browser to open.